

Helios API Platform — Policy and Version History (Combined Archive)

This archive intentionally retains superseded content alongside current content, each dated and labeled | Compiled Rev. 11

This document combines the current Helios API policy handbook with historical policy versions and deprecated API documentation that has not been physically removed, only marked. Every fact below is dated and labeled CURRENT, SUPERSEDED, or DEPRECATED. A correct reader must never treat a SUPERSEDED or DEPRECATED passage as present-day guidance, even though it remains fully readable in this archive.

1. Rate Limiting Policy

1.1 [SUPERSEDED as of 2024-03-01] Original Rate Limit Policy (effective 2021-06-01 to 2024-02-29)

The original Helios rate limit was 100 requests per minute per API key, with no distinction between read and write operations. Exceeding this limit returned HTTP 429 with a flat 60-second retry-after header.

1.2 [CURRENT as of 2024-03-01] Revised Rate Limit Policy

Effective 2024-03-01, Helios splits rate limits by operation type: 300 requests per minute for read operations, 60 requests per minute for write operations, per API key. HTTP 429 responses now include a dynamic retry-after header reflecting actual remaining window time rather than a flat 60 seconds. This policy supersedes Section 1.1 in its entirety and is the policy currently in effect.

2. Authentication

2.1 [DEPRECATED as of 2023-09-15, removed 2024-01-01] API Key Authentication (v1)

The original v1 authentication scheme accepted a static API key passed as a query parameter (?api_key=...). This method was deprecated on 2023-09-15 with a 3.5 month sunset window and fully removed on 2024-01-01. Requests using this method after 2024-01-01 receive HTTP 410 Gone.

2.2 [CURRENT] OAuth 2.0 Bearer Token Authentication (v2)

All requests must include an OAuth 2.0 bearer token in the Authorization header, obtained via the standard client-credentials or authorization-code grant flow. This has been the only supported authentication method since the v1 removal described in Section 2.1.

3. Data Retention Policy

3.1 [SUPERSEDED as of 2023-01-01] Original Data Retention Policy

Under the original policy (in effect 2020-2022), request logs were retained indefinitely with no automatic deletion.

3.2 [SUPERSEDED as of 2024-06-01] First Revision — 90-Day Retention

Effective 2023-01-01, this was revised to a 90-day automatic deletion policy for request logs, replacing the indefinite-retention policy in Section 3.1. This first revision was itself later superseded — see Section 3.3 for the policy currently in effect.

3.3 [CURRENT as of 2024-06-01] Second Revision — 30-Day Retention with Legal Hold Exception

Effective 2024-06-01, retention was shortened further to 30 days for request logs, except when a specific request is placed under legal hold, in which case it is retained until the hold is lifted regardless of the 30-day window. This is the current policy, superseding both Section 3.1 (indefinite) and Section 3.2 (90-day).

4. Pagination

4.1 [DEPRECATED as of 2024-04-01, sunset 2024-10-01] Offset-Based Pagination

The original pagination scheme used `?offset=N&limit;=M` query parameters. This is deprecated as of 2024-04-01 and will stop functioning entirely on 2024-10-01. New integrations should not use this method.

4.2 [CURRENT] Cursor-Based Pagination

The current and only actively recommended pagination method uses an opaque cursor token returned in each response's `next_cursor` field, passed as `?cursor=TOKEN` on the following request. This method scales correctly for large, frequently-changing result sets in a way that offset-based pagination (Section 4.1) does not, since offsets can skip or duplicate records when the underlying data changes between requests.

5. Webhook Signature Verification

5.1 [SUPERSEDED as of 2024-08-01] HMAC-SHA1 Signature Scheme

Webhooks were originally signed using HMAC-SHA1 over the raw request body, with the signature delivered in the X-Helios-Signature header.

5.2 [CURRENT as of 2024-08-01] HMAC-SHA256 Signature Scheme

As of 2024-08-01, webhook signatures use HMAC-SHA256 instead of SHA1, delivered in the same X-Helios-Signature header for backward header-name compatibility, though the signature value itself is computed differently and is not compatible with SHA1 verification code. Integrators still verifying against SHA1 (Section 5.1) will see all signature checks fail after this date and must update their verification code, not just note the change.

6. Frequently Asked Support Questions (Mixed Dates — Read Carefully)

The FAQ below was compiled by support staff over several years and intentionally left unedited; some answers reference policies that were current when written but have since been superseded. Each entry is dated. Always prefer the CURRENT policy sections above (1.2, 2.2, 3.3, 4.2, 5.2) over an FAQ answer if they conflict.

6.1 [Answered 2022-05-10] "What is the rate limit?"

Answer given at the time: 100 requests per minute per API key, no read/write distinction. (This answer reflected Section 1.1, since superseded — see Section 1.2 for the current limits.)

6.2 [Answered 2024-07-20] "How do I paginate large result sets?"

Answer given at the time: use cursor-based pagination with the `next_cursor` field. (This answer reflects the current policy in Section 4.2 and remains accurate.)

6.3 [Answered 2023-11-02] "Can I still use the query-parameter API key?"

Answer given at the time: no, that method (Section 2.1) was already removed as of 2024-01-01 is incorrect to state here — at the time this FAQ entry was written (2023-11-02), v1 key auth was deprecated but not yet fully removed (removal was 2024-01-01); the correct answer as of that specific date was "deprecated, sunset in under two months, migrate now."

7. Version History Summary Table

This table consolidates every policy area covered above with its current status, for quick reference. Rows marked CURRENT reflect what integrators should follow today.

Policy Area	Status	Effective Date	Section
Rate limiting (original)	SUPERSEDED	2021-06-01 to 2024-02-29	1.1
Rate limiting (revised)	CURRENT	2024-03-01	1.2
Auth v1 (query param key)	DEPRECATED / REMOVED	removed 2024-01-01	2.1
Auth v2 (OAuth bearer)	CURRENT	since v1 removal	2.2
Retention (indefinite)	SUPERSEDED	2020-2022	3.1
Retention (90-day)	SUPERSEDED	2023-01-01 to 2024-05-31	3.2
Retention (30-day + legal hold)	CURRENT	2024-06-01	3.3
Pagination (offset-based)	DEPRECATED	sunset 2024-10-01	4.1
Pagination (cursor-based)	CURRENT	ongoing	4.2
Webhook signing (SHA1)	SUPERSEDED	until 2024-07-31	5.1
Webhook signing (SHA256)	CURRENT	2024-08-01	5.2